Red Lion Broadcasting Co. v. *FCC,* 395 U. S. 367, 389–390 (1969); *New York Times Co.* v. *Sullivan,* 376 U. S. 254, 266 (1964); *Associated Press* v. *United States,* 326 U. S. 1, 20 (1945). Similarly, the Court's decisions involving corporations in the business of communication or entertainment are based not only on the role of the First Amendment in fostering individual self-expression but also on its role in affording the public access to discussion, debate, and the dissemination of information and ideas.[19] See *Red Lion Broadcasting Co.* v. *FCC, supra; Stanley* v. *Georgia,* 394 U. S. 557, 564 (1969); *Time, Inc.* v. *Hill,* 385 U. S. 374, 389 (1967). Even decisions seemingly based exclusively on the individual's right to express himself acknowledge that the expression may contribute to society's edification. *Winters* v. *New York,* 333 U. S. 507, 510 (1948).

Nor do our recent commercial speech cases lend support to appellee's business interest theory. They illustrate that the First Amendment goes beyond protection of the press and the self-expression of individuals to prohibit government from limiting the stock of information from which members of the public may draw. A commercial advertisement is constitutionally protected not so much because it pertains to the seller's business as because it furthers the societal interest in the "free flow of commercial information." *Virginia State Bd. of Pharmacy* v. *Virginia Citizens Consumer Council,* 425 U. S. 748, 764 (1976); see *Linmark Associates, Inc.* v. *Willingboro,* 431 U. S. 85, 95 (1977).[20]

---

[19] The suggestion in MR. JUSTICE WHITE's dissent, *post,* at 807, that the First Amendment affords less protection to ideas that are not the product of "individual choice" would seem to apply to newspaper editorials and every other form of speech created under the auspices of a corporate body. No decision of this Court lends support to such a restrictive notion.

[20] It is somewhat ironic that appellee seeks to reconcile these decisions with the "materially affecting" concept by noting that the commercial speaker would "have a direct financial interest in the speech," Brief for Appellee 19, and n. 12. Until recently, the "purely commercial" nature